

CITY COUNCIL AGENDA ITEM COVER SHEET

DATE OF COUNCIL MEETING: October 24, 2011

TYPE OF DOCUMENT: (____ORDINANCE) (____RESOLUTION) (____PRELIMINARY
PLAT/PRELIM ZONE CHANGE) (X LEASE/CONTRACT) (____CHANGE ORDER/CONTRACT
MODIFICATION) (____CONSIDER BID) (____APPLICATIONS/LICENSES/PERMITS)
(____APPOINTMENTS) (____ANNOUNCEMENTS/REPORTS/MOTIONS) (____OTHER)

SPONSOR(S) : (ORDINANCES/RESOLUTIONS ONLY)

EXACT WORDING OF ENTITLEMENT/ITEM: Amendment Number One To The Community Based Family Support and Preservation Grant Contract between Wyoming Department of Family Services, Protective Services Division and City of Cheyenne - Youth Alternatives.

(1% Sales Tax Funding/Years

(Other Funding _____) (Grant \$22,400.00)

CONTACT PERSON: Dick Berry PHONE: 637-6480 DEPT.: Youth Alternatives

OTHER CITY DEPTS AFFECTED: None

OTHER GOV'T AGENCIES AFFECTED:

FINANCIAL IMPACT PROPOSED OR CONDITIONS WHICH AFFECT CITY: The City will receive \$22,400 for services. Invoices and reports are required. 30% in-kind match is required.

CONTRACT TERM: September 30, 2012 STARTING DATE: October 1, 2011

	YES	NO	N/A
Is funding budgeted?	(<u>x</u>)	(<u> </u>)	(<u> </u>)
Were Bids called for?	(<u> </u>)	(<u> </u>)	(<u>x</u>)
Affected parties notified of Council procedure & dates?	(<u>x</u>)	(<u> </u>)	(<u> </u>)
Has bond, insurance or other security been arranged?	(<u> </u>)	(<u> </u>)	(<u>x</u>)
Have legal descriptions been checked?	(<u> </u>)	(<u> </u>)	(<u>x</u>)

Agenda item reviewed and/or approved by:

Risk Mgr (x) City Attorney (x) Dept. Head (x)

General Comments: Funding will provide support for part-time family counselor to provide services for families who have a youth returning from an out-of-home placement.

Submitted by: Dick Berry Title: Clinical Director Date: 10-10-11

UPON PASSAGE OF THIS AGENDA ITEM, COPIES SHOULD BE SENT TO:

Dick Berry/Ronn Jeffrey

**Amendment Number One to the
Community Based Family Support and Preservation Contract between
Wyoming Department of Family Services, Protective Services Division and
City of Cheyenne – Youth Alternatives**

1. **Parties.** This Amendment is made and entered into by and between the State of Wyoming, Department of Family Services, Protective Services Division [Agency], whose address is Hathaway Building, Third Floor, 2300 Capitol Avenue, Cheyenne, WY 82002 and City of Cheyenne – Youth Alternatives [Contractor], whose address is 1328 Talbot Court, Cheyenne, WY 82001.

2. **Purpose of Amendment.** This Amendment shall constitute the First Amendment to the Contract between the Agency and the Contractor which was duly executed on April 6, 2011 and which became effective April 6, 2011. The purpose of this Amendment is to:

A. Provide funding to extend the Original Contract for one (1) year from October 1, 2011 through September 30, 2012. The total amount of this Amendment is Twenty-Two Thousand Four Hundred Dollars (\$22,400.00).

The total amount of this Amendment is

B. Change 5. **Responsibilities of Contractor B** to read:

(i) Invoice

(A) Submit monthly, expenditure invoices;

(B) Submit quarterly, detailed program reports by January 15, 2010; April 15, 2012; June 15, 2012 and October 15, 2012. The report must include a list of youth (numbers and names) by each service provided and what outcomes were achieved for the youth for the month;

(C) The Contractor shall provide, upon the written request of the Agency, required reports/records within fifteen (15) working days of the request, including; but not limited to:

(i) Financial report(s), progress report(s), program evaluation report(s), and Year-end Budget Analysis report(s);

(ii) Any product, materials, and/or media developed (if applicable);

(iii) Accompanying legible receipts and verifications regarding finances; and

(iv) Any other reports as requested by the Agency.

(D) No equipment purchases allowed.

(ii) The Original Contract, dated April 6, 2011 provided funds to the Contractor for to provide Three (3), Time-Limited Reunification Services in the amount of Twenty-Two Thousand Four Hundred Dollars (\$22,400.00), with an expiration date of September 30, 2012.

3. **Term of the Amendment.** This Amendment shall commence upon the date the last required signature is affixed hereto, and shall remain in full force and effect through September 30, 2012, unless terminated at an earlier date pursuant to the provisions of the Contract, or pursuant to federal or state statute or rule or regulation.

4. **Payment.** The Agency agrees to pay Contractor for the services described in the Original Contract. As a result of this Amendment, the total payment under the Original Contract, as amended, shall not exceed Forty-Four Thousand Eight Hundred Dollars (\$44,800.00). Payment shall be made on a monthly basis and is subject to all terms and conditions in the Original Contract. This Amendment requires a thirty percent (30%) match (in-kind, cash, or other as negotiated by the Contractor); match amount is Nine Thousand Six Hundred Dollars (\$9,600.00). The administrative costs are ten percent (10%) of the grant amount which is Two Thousand Two Hundred Forty Dollars (\$2,240.00). The match and administrative costs must be reported each month and are described in the Contractor's budget which is attached hereto as Attachment B and incorporated herein by reference.

If the Contractor's yearly total of contracted dollars exceeds Five Hundred Thousand Dollars (\$500,000.00) of federal funds, regardless of the source, the Contractor is required to have a single or program-specific audit conducted in accordance with the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular A-133. The Contractor shall furnish DFS a copy of the final audit, along with the Contractor's responses to the audit.

5. **Additional Responsibilities of Contractor.** The Contractor has no additional responsibilities as a result of this Amendment.

6. **Additional Responsibilities of Agency.** The Agency has no additional responsibilities as a result of this Amendment.

7. **Special Provisions. Same terms and Conditions.** With the exception of items explicitly delineated in this Amendment, all terms and conditions of the Original Contract between the Agency and the Contractor, including but not limited to sovereign immunity, and including all prior amendments to the Original Contract shall remain unchanged and in full force and effect.

8. **General Provisions. Entirety of Contract.** This Amendment, consisting of three (3) pages; the Original Contract, consisting of ten (10) pages; Attachment A, consisting of thirty-nine (39) pages; and Attachment B, consisting of two (2) pages, represents the entire and integrated Contract between the parties and supersedes all prior negotiations, representations, and agreements, whether written or oral.

9. **Signatures.** IN WITNESS THEREOF, the parties to this Amendment through their duly authorized representatives have executed this Amendment, known as Amendment One to the Contract between the Agency and the Contractor, on the days and dates set out below, and certify that they have read, understood, and agreed to the terms and conditions of this Amendment as set forth herein.

This Amendment is not binding on either party until approved by A&I Procurement and the Governor of the State of Wyoming or his designee, if required by Wyo. Stat. § 9-2-1016(b)(iv).

The effective date of this Amendment is the date of the signature last affixed to this page.

DEPARTMENT OF FAMILY SERVICES

Steve Corsi, Director

Date

Eydie Trautwein, Administrator
Protective Services Division

Date

**CONTRACTOR
CITY OF CHEYENNE YOUTH ALTERNATIVES**

Richard L. Kaysen, Mayor

Date

ATTEST:

Carol A. Intlakofer, City Clerk

Date

YOUTH ALTERNATIVES

Dick Berry, Director

Date

ATTORNEY GENERAL'S OFFICE APPROVAL AS TO FORM

Cara B. Chambers # 79057
Cara Boyle Chambers, Assistant Attorney General

9/22/11
Date

ATTACHMENT A

**DEPARTMENT OF FAMILY SERVICES
RE-ENTRY SERVICES**

**YOUTH ALTERNATIVES
SUBMISSION FOR RFP NO. 0136-U**

I. Cover Sheet

Primary Contact Person: Richard Berry, Psy.D.

Project Name: PROJECT H.O.M.E.

Funding Area Served: Funding Area 3. Time-Limited Family Reunification Services

Organization: Office of Youth Alternatives (OYA)

Address: 1328 Talbot Court **Tax Identification Number:** 83-6000050

City: Cheyenne **State:** WY **Zip:** 82001

Phone Number: (307) 637-6480 **Fax Number:** (307) 637-6237

Email: dberry@cheyennecity.org

Richard Berry, Psy.D.

Date

II. PROGRAM SUMMARY

In 2009, Laramie County had 122 placements with an average of 86.25 youth in placement, which was the highest in the state. The average length of a placement was 307.12 days. Laramie County has the most placement days (29,987) of any county in the state. Thirty five youth (28.69%) returned to a residential facility, resulting in a second placement.

A great deal of time and resources are focused on getting a child into an out-of-home placement, but little on getting him out. This unbalanced approach significantly negates the initial time and financial investment because no one helps the child and family apply in their home what was learned in the placement. We know times of transition are points of high stress, requiring extra support and thoughtful interventions. Project H.O.M.E. will address this significant lapse in the juvenile system, increasing the success of integrating children back into their homes, schools and community. This project will also reduce the number of youth returning to a second out-of-home placement by providing the needed support for the youth, family, and community.

Because of the need to reduce placements, the Department of Family Services came to Youth Alternatives three years ago and asked if we would apply for funding to begin a transition program. The initial funding was for a half-time family therapist through a Family Preservation Grant and a youth mentor through a Diversion Grant. After the second year, the funding for the half-time family therapist was reduced. Because we felt so strongly about the program, we continued to subsidize the therapist to continue to work with the transitional families. We can no longer do that. We are thus applying for funding for the half-time family counselor, and some mileage support. We currently receive funding from another grant for the Youth Mentor.

It is thus our plan to meet the goals of the Time-Limited Family Reunification Services through Project H.O.M.E.

PROJECT H.O.M.E.

For the past three years Youth Alternatives has assisted youth to successfully return to their home, school, and community. Because of our work with the returning youth and their families, we believe we can provide the needed energy, experience and expertise to reunify the child safely within the stated time frame, and reduce the number of second placements.

The acronym H.O.M.E. covers many of the program components:

H: Home - everyone in the home is eligible to receive supportive services. Support and accountability for all family members increases the likelihood of a successful reunification. Additionally, the services will primarily be provided in the family's home. This increases family participation, and improves the match between the need and the service provided.

O: Others - Developing a supportive Core Team for the family who supports the reunification home is critical to the family's success. Collaboration with others (family relatives, coach, pastor, neighbor, scout leader, D.F.S., District Attorney's Office, school personnel, and other community agencies) will be extremely helpful in providing wrap around services for the family. This Core Team would be there for the family and provide meaningful support.

M: Mentor - The Mentor's contact with the youth meets some of the social and support needs of the youth. Most returning youth don't have a positive peer group available, so they reconnect with negative peers and a fall back to old behaviors that contributed to their placement. The mentor will bridge this social gap. Additionally, the mentor-youth relationship exerts a powerful influence on the youth and his behavior. The time with the mentor has also served as a needed respite for the parents, reducing the family tension. The Mentor also supports the youth through the difficult transition to home, school and community.

E: Evaluation/Educators - Evaluation of the family is critical to develop goals and a plan that will move the family to a safe and functional way of interacting. Knowing where the family has been, their strengths, and where they want to be is the first step in developing a workable family plan. This evaluation focuses on the family's strengths and their ability to support each other.

Educators from the child's school are critical team members. Several schools have designated an Adult Liaison (AL) for at-risk students. The AL takes a personal interest in the student, keeping others aware of circumstances and progress, checking credit concerns, and scheduling school visits. Keeping the youth in school is crucial to his/her long term success. Without the Educators involvement all along the way, the chances of the youth's return to his/her home school are low.

A. Population Served

1. Youth (ages 6-17): The primary population to be served are youth ages 6-17 who are returning from an out-of-home residential placement, foster care, or who are coming to the community from another residence. While the majority of referrals will come from the Department of Family Services, we also receive many referrals of youth coming to Cheyenne from out-of-town or out-of-state homes. Frustrated single parents often send their difficult out-of-control child to live with the other parent. Providing services for these at-risk youth at the early stages of their transitions will also reduce the number of potential placements.

2. Parents and Family Members: Focusing solely on the youth cannot be effective for the youth, family, school or community. Parents and other family members must be included in those receiving services. Although often well meaning, some parents have poor parenting skills or significant issues of their own, which interfere with them providing adequate structure, direction and appropriate parenting. These deficits require support and intervention. Parents often feel isolated and blamed, resulting in their hesitancy to participate in available services. If they felt like they were a part of a supportive team who together were working for their family success, their participation would surely increase.

3. Community Support People: Recruiting a Core Team of community support people is critical for providing the needed support for the youth and his family. Keeping educators in the loop of the youth's progress is essential for reintegration back into the school setting.

B. Intent of the Program

The intent of the Project H.O.M.E. is to provide the needed services to successfully transition the youth into his home, school and community. Once the youth is home, the intent is to keep him there. This is made somewhat more difficult due to the initial placement. Once that first placement has been made, placement now becomes an option in the choices the parents and community consider. Successful reintegration into the community negates the need for another placement. Our staff would work diligently to help the youth return and find a place where he could be successful.

C. Geographic Area to Be Covered

Laramie County is the area of focus. As was noted earlier, much could be done to reduce many of the statistics associated with placements. Impacting Laramie County would greatly reduce the state budget.

D. Lead Agency or Organization

Youth Alternatives is the lead agency.

E. Goals of the Program

As was stated earlier, the goal of Project H.O.M.E. is to provide Time-Limited Family Reunification Services so the youth can be safely and successfully integrated back into his home, school and community.

III. PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

A. GOALS/PURPOSES AND OUTCOMES

Project H.O.M.E. would provide the appropriate services needed to facilitate a positive and safe reintegration of the youth into his family. We have been very effective in helping youth get off probation, obtain a job, be clean and sober, finish school or obtain a G.E.D., and move to a more independent type of living arrangement like independent living, foster care or the Job Corps.

Over the past three years, we've come to more thoroughly understand the needs of those involved in placement situations.

Youth Needs: Youth need more frequent (but usually briefer) contact in order to keep moving on their plan and to not revert back to old behavior. This often means meeting them on their turf, providing specific direction for specific situations and texting them and allowing them to text the service provider. This approach has allowed a strong positive connection between the youth, the mentor, and the family therapist. When this kind of connection is made, the probability of the youth calling the mentor or the family therapist before making a poor decision is greatly increased.

Returning youth need significant support to make positive school choices. It has been extremely difficult for them to re-connect with their home school. Their major way of dealing with this issue has been to avoid it when possible. We believe the reason for this struggle is the disconnect between the youth and school people. Ways of keeping the home school involved throughout the whole process needs additional work. It has been difficult to arrange school visits concurrent with home visits. Funding and other issues interfere with adequate time for the youth to connect with the school when he/she is on a home visit. The youth and school personnel need to have many contacts during the placement to increase the likelihood of a successful school

reunification. Having the case manager, mentor or family counselor go with the youth to school has been successful when it has occurred.

To solve the school problem, many youth have chosen to work on their G.E.D. instead of going back to the public school. The Goal Program offered through our office and L.C.C.C. has been a positive way of moving ahead academically. The youth through the support of the family counselor and the mentor have identified and prioritized their options, but generally the public school option has not been one they have chosen. These are good options, but it would be important to use these as second choices, not the primary educational choice.

Kids need social connections. Upon their return, we've seen kids struggle with developing new positive habits and social activities. The strong mentor relationship has allowed the youth to avoid the social isolation while attempting to associate with a different peer group. Going to the YMCA, getting assistance in finding a job, and learning new social skills have been the focus of many of the supportive activities.

Parental and Familial Needs: Parents need to be listened to and provided services that meet their perceived needs. Many parents at this point are very tired and are looking for support and direction relative to their specific needs. Parents have not wanted yet another round of regular services, tying up several of their evenings. But they do want support. We've found that providing customized services has suited many parents very well. This means in-home services are more important than in-office meetings, and availability in the evenings or weekends when problems arise are perceived as being significantly more helpful. Knowing the family therapist is available to answer questions and meet when needed has been appreciated by the parents. The family therapist will have the flexibility to respond to the families relative to their needs. At one point, two parent group meetings were conducted to assist with specific transitional concerns. Once those issues were addressed, the parents weren't interested in continuing with an ongoing group.

Community Support People Needs: Once a youth is placed outside of his home, many people involved with him quickly become focused on the needs of other youth who are still in the school or community. The community support people need brief concise updated information about the placed student that provides direction and gives them a specific role or task to complete. Without periodic updates on how the student is progressing, the school personnel don't have the opportunity to shift their perceptions and personal feelings concerning the student, and then have an understandably difficult time matching up with the student's progress when he returns.

School personnel, probation officers and other professional people need to be persistently contacted with clear requests of how they might participate in the youth's reintegration home. Advising community support people of Multidisciplinary Team Meetings (M.D.T.s) and other meetings has been useful.

Mentor would:

- ▶ Help youth develop other coping skills.
- ▶ Support youth in recreational and social activities.
- ▶ Assist youth with job applications.
- ▶ Provide brief respite at times for parents.
- ▶ Provide crisis support to youth and family.
- ▶ Be available through a variety of means beyond office hours and weekdays.

Family Counselor would:

- ▶ Consult with facility to smooth transition home.
- ▶ Consult with facility to make sure discharge plan is working.
- ▶ Provide family therapy.
- ▶ Provide crisis intervention 24/7.

B. Key Components of Project H.O.M.E.

As stated earlier, the needs assessment data indicates that Laramie County places many youth, for long periods of time, and often has to place them for a second time. The cost - emotionally, financially, academically, and socially - is quite significant. Project H.O.M.E. has the following key components:

- ▶ **Proven Experience:** We have been working with youth and their families on this particular issue for the past three years. We also focus on families and family issues. We use Functional Family Therapy (FFT) (best practice model) to understand and assist families to understand and solve their problems.
- ▶ **Family Expertise:** Youth Alternatives has two clinical Members of the American Association For Marriage and Family Therapists who hold Marriage and Family Therapy Licenses through the state. Additionally one is also a certified Supervisor of Marriage and Family Therapy. Youth Alternatives is a recognized training site for Marriage and Family Internships through Colorado State University. Both licensed therapists have written books on Family Therapy.
- ▶ **Family Systems Approach:** Family tension, safety, resolving conflict, growing through developmental stages, and transitioning in and out of the home are all family system issues. All of the staff involved are family focused systems oriented individuals. We understand families and can provide strength-based family assessments.
- ▶ **Strength Based Approach:** Engaging struggling families can be difficult. Approaching from a strength basis is a best practice approach. This is not a new concept for us, but a practiced skill of many years.
- ▶ **Community Involvement:** It is crucial to develop a Core Team around these youth and families. Typically there are many people who would be quite willing to be involved, but they need some structure and direction as to the role they could play. Coordinating the community players would make all of the services much more productive. Because Youth Alternatives has been in Cheyenne since 1971, we are connected with all of the major providers of youth services.

Services Provided to Achieve Outcome

For referred families, the following services will be available:

1. **Case Management:** The family therapist and youth mentor will be the organizational hub for the family, the services and the Core Team of individuals who are involved with the family. This service will ensure that important dates and services are tracked and monitored. Progress will be monitored and significant information will be regularly conveyed to D.F.S. personnel. The family therapist will supervise the case manager and mentor.

2. **Family Assessment**: The family therapist will complete a family assessment to understand the family's dynamics, strengths, values, needs, and concerns. Developing a comprehensive treatment plan, incorporating family, school, and community goals will be important in focusing the services.

3. **Youth Mentoring**: The youth mentor will be available to the youth beyond office hours and week days. The mentor will have numerous weekly contacts with the youth, focusing on the agreed upon probation, family, school, and community goals.

4. **Community Networking**: Advocating for the family would include attendance at M.D.T.s and other meetings. Providing treatment information and communicating with other community agencies to provide needed services would also be included in the community networking.

5. **Goal Setting Session**: The family therapist and youth mentor will meet with the Department of Family Services Probation Officer or other D.F.S. designee, and other core team members (school district personnel and other supportive individuals). Case goals will be established.

6. **Family Counseling**: The family therapist will offer family counseling for participating families, conduct parenting groups, and also provide case manager and mentor supervision.

7. **School Networking and Monitoring of Academic Performance and Attendance**: The youth mentor would maintain contact with the school personnel. Including school personnel greatly increases the likelihood of success. Monitoring and reinforcing attendance is connected to positive academic performance. The mentor could encourage the youth to attend, even providing transportation at times if needed.

8. **Crisis Support 24/7/365**: In addition to the service provided by the Project, the families will also have access to the crisis services through Youth Alternatives. We are available by phone at any time. The family therapist provided for by this grant would also be available to assist with crisis support.

9. **Parent Education Classes/Parent Support Group**: Parenting groups are available specifically for parents of youth returning from placement. These would be facilitated by the family therapist. Additionally, an ongoing six session parenting group is available for parents. They can join the group on any Thursday and complete the following consecutive five Thursday meetings to complete the class.

10. **Liaison Services with the Residential Facility**: The family therapist will contact the residential facility, clarifying the youth's progress, potential discharge date, school and credit concerns, medication issues and services needed upon discharge.

C. Current Program Data

Attached please find the FAMILY PRESERVATION Quarterly Progress Report dated July 1, 2010 - September, 2010.

Briefly from the report:

1. **Number of Youth Served**: During the time of the grant (December, 2009 - September 30, 2010), a total of twenty four (24) youth and their families received services from the part-time family therapist that the grant supported. This exceeds the fifteen families that we committed to seeing.

2. Number Successfully Transitioned: Out of the twenty four youth referred, fifteen youth, (62%) successfully transitioned back into the homes. Five youth (21%) were subsequently placed in foster care, needing a less structured and less expensive placement. While these youth had made progress, the family situation was still difficult for them to manage. They did remain in the community and were not re-placed in another residential facility.

3. Number Re-Referred To Another Residential Placement: Four youth (17%) were placed back into a similar residential placement, one went to N.S.I., one went to Cathedral Home, one went to a psychiatric facility in Utah, and one went to adult prison.

4. Number Completing Probation Successfully: Sixteen youth (67%) of the youth successfully completed probation and had their case closed. Of the remaining eight who had significant probation violations, four of them went on to successfully complete their probation. Thus 84% were successful in being positively released from their probation.

5. Number Completing or Remaining In School: Although we knew it would be difficult for youth to return to their home school, many youth successfully did that or completed their G.E.D. Fourteen youth (58%) are still in school. One youth (4%) graduated. Five youth (21%) completed their G.E.D. Four youth (17%) dropped out of school or are not currently attending.

6. Length of time receiving services: Youth and their families received services sometimes over a substantial length of time. Twelve youth (50%) received services only during one of the quarters. Ten youth (42%) received services during two quarters. Two youth (8%) received services during the entire period of the grant.

D. Important Dates of the Program: Beginning, Ending, Training, etc.

The program would continue through the end of our current contract, which ended September 30, 2010. This funding would allow us to continue (not begin) to operate our program, working with the youth currently involved in the program and picking up new families as they become available. (Note: just because the previous funding ends, does not mean that services are not still needed for those families already in the transition process.)

E. Program Results and Quality Assurance

Based on the goals of the program, the following outcomes are highlighted:

- ▶ Reduce the number of youth returning to a second out-of-home placement: The goal would be for 80% of the youth to avoid a second residential placement.

Youth receiving services will be tracked for their school attendance and grades, success at living at home, probation success and additional placements made. Additionally, termination evaluations will be obtained from the youth and parents.

F. Target Population and Numbers Served

As stated earlier the target population is as follows:

- ▶ Youth 6-18 who are returning from an out-of-home placements, and other high-risk youth coming to the community from another residence.
- ▶ Parents and family members
- ▶ Community support team - Core Team of supporters for the family

Also as previously stated, we already have a case load of families who are going through the transitional phase. In addition to these families, we could pick up an additional **twenty families (20)** starting July 1, 2010.

G. Best Practices

1. **Functional Family Therapy:** The family therapy offered to these families will be a modified version of Functional Family Therapy, a best practice model. We've been trained in this model and find it very helpful for families as it generates hope and allows the family to look at the problem behaviors from a different perspective. This change in perspective is crucial in that it creates more flexibility in responding to the behaviors that typically caused relational and legal problems.

- ▶ Barton, Alexander, Waldron, Turner & Warburton (1985) in a study involving children and adolescents at risk for foster care placement, FFT showed a significant decrease in rates of out-of-home placements, and a decrease in the number of contacts per case.
- ▶ Gordon, Arbuthnot, Gustafson & McGreen (1988) studied delinquents with multiple offenses who were at risk for out-of-home placements. They found that clients receiving FFT had a lower rate of recidivism and committed fewer offenses at a two year follow up. Additionally those receiving FFT services had lower recidivism rates as adults.
- ▶ Klein, Alexander, and Parsons (1977) demonstrated that siblings in families that received FFT had a lower rate of court referrals than other treatments.

2. **Mentoring:** Mentoring has been shown to be an effective intervention with juveniles. This has also been our experience with transitioning youth.

- ▶ Child Trends (2002), a national research center, showed the following outcomes from mentoring:
 - Positive academic outcomes**, including better school attendance, increased chances of enrolling in higher education, and more positive attitudes toward school.
 - Prevention of youth risk behaviors**, including lower rates of substance use and abuse, and delinquent acts.
 - Enhanced social and emotional development**, including positive attitudes about the future and the elderly, an increase in helping behaviors, and better trust of and communication with parents.
- ▶ National Mentoring Center demonstrated that youth participating in mentoring programs are:
 - 27% less likely to start drinking
 - 46% less likely to become involved with drugs
 - 52% less likely to skip a day of school

33% less likely to hit someone
64% develop more favorable attitudes toward school
56% report improved peer relationships
64% develop increased levels of self confidence

3. **In-Home Services:** There is a correlation between how often and where services are offered with treatment outcomes. Offering services in the home greatly increases a positive outcome.

- Brooks et al (2000) showed that increased rates of in-home contact produced greater age-appropriate expectations, better family communication, increased attention to the child's needs, improved marital relationships, and an improvement in the child's willingness to accept discipline.

H. Specific Geographic Area To Be Served

Laramie County is the geographical area to be served, with an emphasis on Cheyenne as this is the largest populated town in the county. Laramie County places large numbers of youth as indicated from the statistics presented earlier in this proposal.

I. Extent of Community Partners

As indicated by our project title Other, community members are crucial in supporting a positive transition for the youth and family. We've collaborated with or will collaborate with:

1. **Core Support Team.** Many families have people like coaches, pastors, and neighbors who are willing to help support the child and family through a variety of practical ways. Program alumni from a specific residential facility may also be a group of people who could provide focused support to the youth and family. Determining who these people are, and requesting their assistance will enhance the family's ability to be successful.
2. **Family/Relatives.** Many families have significant resources in other family members. Unfortunately many of these have not been allowed to participate in MDT meetings or court hearings. These people could offer assistance if there was a way for them to help. Determining who they are and how they might help will increase connections and support.
3. **Placement Facilities.** Coordinating discharge plans with the facility keeps the team advised of transitional issues like discharge date, credit transfer, medication monitoring and refills, and re-entry into the child's school.
4. **School District Number One.** We will be collaborating with School Districts #1 and #2, including the principals, counselors, social workers, psychologists, and specific teachers at each school where the youth attends. We will make specific contact with AL for each of the students and keep that person advised. AL will play a key role in helping the student successfully return to school.
5. **D.F.S.** We will collaborate with D.F.S. for referrals and coordinated treatment approaches with their caseworkers, probation officers and supervisors. D.F.S. may be able to provide respite care at times when the family needs a break. The local D.F.S. worker of course will be involved with the discharge planning and treatment goals. The

worker will be advised of the progress and any concerns that may develop. His/her participation in the transitional period will encourage the family to follow through.

While our connection with the local D.F.S. is almost four decades in duration, Project H.O.M.E. has worked specifically regarding this issue and with these youth for the past three years. Working out the expectations and establishing ways of communicating and sharing information for all parties has been an important part of collaboration. Those mechanisms (referral, follow up, updating, communication) are currently in place and functioning at a productive level.

6. **District Attorney's Office.** The attorney who works with the juveniles will be involved with the discharge planning and legal impetus to follow through on any court orders or concerns. We will be advising the D.A. of the progress through the transitional period. Similarly to our relationship with D.F.S., we have a long history of working with the District Attorney's Office. Collaboration is positive.
7. **The Attention Home.** In some cases it would be appropriate to provide a brief transitional placement for the youth so he/she isn't making all of the adjustments at once. This could be an alternative living placement or an alternative educational placement. These arrangements can be created with the Attention Home depending on the needs of the youth and family. Attention Home is supportive of our transitional work as indicated by their support letter.
8. **Other Community Agencies.** Other community agencies will be involved on an as-needed basis. Those could include agencies like Peak Wellness, Behavioral Health, Pathfinder, J.E.M.S., etc.

J. Program Operating Hours

The program will be essentially 24/7 for the entire year of the funding. The mentor is typically on call 24/7 to respond to any concerns, questions, calls or texts from the youth. She does a significant amount of work on the weekends and after regular business hours. The family counselor is often available 24/7 as well. Family sessions are coordinated and scheduled at times when the family is available, with most of the sessions facilitated in the home. At times when the counselor is not available, the on-call emergency service operated through Youth Alternatives is always available. These families are granted significant and easy access to our services.

K. Performance Measures

1. Percentage of youth successfully transitioning into their home, avoiding another out-of home residential placement.
2. Percentage of youth who are placed in a lesser restrictive setting - like foster care.
3. Percentage of students successfully returning and staying in their home school.
4. Percentage of students remaining enrolled in school will be determined.
5. Percent of youth who are positively released from probation.
6. Monthly evaluations will be obtained from the parents and youth to make sure we are providing needed and appropriate services.
7. Termination evaluations will be obtained from families participating in the program.

L. Data Collection Methods

The family therapist will be responsible for obtaining the following data from families referred to Project H.O.M.E.:

1. Number of families accepted into the program
2. Monthly evaluation forms will be filled out by family members to receive feedback regarding their satisfaction with the services they've received.
3. Percentage of youth remaining in school will be obtained at the 180 day time frame.
4. Percentage of youth remaining in their home will be obtained at the 180 day time frame.

The case manager will keep track of number of referrals, dates of referrals, termination dates, number of placements, number of second placements, and other outcomes like being positively released from probation, new charges, other program or placements like Job Corps or the National Guard Boot Camp. This information will be tracked and presented as youth leave the program and as the year of their discharge occurs.

M. Program Replication

Replication of the program in other areas can be done relatively easily if there are trained marriage and family therapists available. The assessment format and forms generated to track the families and youth would be shared. We would be glad to consult with other counties to assist in the implementation of a similar program.

N. Program Evaluation

EVALUATION TOOLS TO MEASURE PROGRAM OUTCOME

1. Percentage of youth remaining in their home, avoiding another out-of home placement.
2. Percentage of students successfully returning and staying in their home school.
3. Percentage of students remaining enrolled in school will be determined.
4. Monthly evaluations will be obtained from the parents and youth to make sure we are providing needed and appropriate services.
5. Termination evaluations will be obtained from families participating in the program.

O. Track Results One Year Post Program

The family counselor will keep track of the number of referrals made to the program. At one year anniversaries of termination, the case manager will contact either the Department of Family Services or the District Attorney's Office to determine if a second out-of-home placement occurred. Other important data will be school/academic progress, success on probation, job retention, and positive movement into self-sufficiency.

IV. COST PROPOSAL

Cost Proposal

\$22,400

1. Total Cost Requested from RFP

Detailed Budget Narrative

A. Personnel

i. Family Therapist

(Salary of \$20,000)

\$20,000

The family therapist will be responsible for conducting the family assessments, providing family counseling, and supervising the family specialist and youth mentor as well as additional duties as previously described.

B. Non-Personnel

\$2,400

i. Travel

It is imperative that the staff in this program have mobility. They need to be able to go to the families' houses for sessions, crisis situations, and other necessary meetings. This amount subsidizes the staff's mileage. Each of the two staff would be subsidized \$100/month for twelve months to offset the cost of their travel. Additional costs are absorbed by the Office of Youth Alternatives.

COST-BENEFITS:

The grant award of \$22,400 would provide transitional services for youth, the family, and the core team. The funding would continue the work with the presently referred youth and their families and for up to twenty new family referrals. The cost of out-of-home placements is approximately \$48,000 - \$60,000/year. If Project H.O.M.E. keeps youth in their homes, avoiding another out of home placement, the savings would be significant. Keeping even one child from returning to a placement would more than double the cost of this program in savings.

Additionally, if the youth ends up in another placement and not with his family, that initial placement investment has not been cost effective, nor did it reach the intended goal. Plus additional funds need to be expended for the second placement.

This of course only deals with the financial cost, and does not begin to address the emotional concerns or the life-long pattern of behavior that becomes ingrained in a young person, often resulting in involvement with the adult legal system for many years.

Keeping two youth out of placement would pay for the program.

Other Funding Sources

We believe that we are all in this together and the kids in Cheyenne are all of our kids. Because of that we are applying to get this grant to help cover the costs of actually providing a program that would benefit our kids, our families and our community. However, clearly the phone costs, mileage, and other supportive services costs will continue to be supported supplemented by our general budget.

Administrative Costs

With the current budget, administrative costs would be 6.5%.

PROPOSED BUDGET

Program Title: Youth Alternatives Project H.O.M.E.

Date: 05-26-10

501(c)(3)	AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP	INCOME FROM OTHER SOURCES	TOTAL PROGRAM EXPENSES
PERSONNEL			
STAFF	\$20,000		\$20,000
CONSULTANTS		\$1,500	\$1,500
TOTAL PERSONNEL A	\$20,000	\$1,500	\$21,500

NON-PERSONNEL			
SPACE COSTS (Rent/utilities)	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT	\$2,500	\$2,500
TELEPHONE		\$400	\$400
POSTAGE			
CONSUMABLE SUPPLIES		\$400	\$400
PRINTING		\$100	\$100
TRAVEL	\$2,400	\$1,200	\$3,600
EQUIPMENT	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT		
OTHER COSTS			
Administrative		\$3,500	\$3,500
TOTAL NON-PERSONNEL B.	\$2,400	\$8,100	\$10,500
TOTAL AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP IS A+B+C	\$22,400	\$9,600	\$32,000

(1) Include a narrative of specific costs such as workshop mailing, materials, books, pamphlets and staff (per hour, benefits, etc.)

(2) Income from other sources can include in-kind match in such areas as office space, supplies, equipment, utility costs and volunteer services.

ATTACHMENTS:

Attachment 1: Employees and Compensation Officers and Board of Directors

Attachment 2: Brief History of Organization

Attachment 3: 3 Letters of Endorsement

Attachment 4: Liability Insurance

Attachment 5: Current Financial Statement

Attachment 6: Current Financial Audit

Attachment 7: Certificate of Good Standing

Attachment 8: Copy of Previous Progress Reports

Attachment 9: List of Board Members

Attachment 1: Employees and Compensation

Family Therapist: Full Time @ \$40,000/year plus 15% benefits= \$46,000
Case Manager: Full Time @ \$32,000/year plus 15% benefits= \$36,800

Attachment 2: Brief History of Organization

History of Organization

Youth Alternatives is a department of the City of Cheyenne and is a government agency. The program was established in 1971 to provide services to youth placed on probation in the City of Cheyenne. The program received national recognition as an exemplary Model Cities Project. Congressman Teno Roncalio spoke about the program before Congress in 1974 and in 1975 the program was selected to appear in a book of exemplary projects.

In 1977, the program received a letter of commendation from President Jimmy Carter and the George Washington Honor Medal from the Freedom Foundation in Philadelphia. In 1980, the distinguished Jefferson Award, from the Jefferson Foundations was awarded to the program.

In 1990, the program was recognized for outstanding volunteer achievement by President George Bush and was designated as the 247th Point of Light and in 1991 the program received a medal commemorating this honor at a ceremony in Florida.

To date, our services have grown to include: family counseling, court services, pre-court diversion, probation, juvenile alcohol & drug intervention program, electronic monitoring, work alternatives program, group services, school services, family crisis intervention, community challenge course, and Special Friends - our mentoring program.

Youth Alternatives provides the City of Cheyenne with a coordinated response to the needs of troubled youth in the community. The program utilizes the community as a tool to modify the inappropriate behavior of troubled youth. The program is designed to intervene in the lives of young people at an impressionable state in their growth and curtail their continuance or entrance into the juvenile justice system. The program attempts to assist troubled youth to see themselves as better people and the world as less hostile by providing preventative, supportive, and rehabilitative services.

Attachment 3: Letters of Endorsement

Scott Homar
District Attorney
First Judicial District

Dr. Mike Klopfenstein
Assistant Superintendent for Instruction
School District Number One

Robert Fecht
Attention Homes, Inc.

Attachment 4: Liability Insurance

Certificate of Liability Coverage

See copy of attached certificate from Wyoming Association of Risk Management

Attachment 5: Current Financial Statement

**As per Lori Galles on 05-20 @10:45am
One copy of the current financial statement
needs to be included in the packet.
Advising the committee as to where they can view it on the web
would be sufficient for the remainder of the packets.**

**Current Financial Statement
Youth Alternatives is a Division of the City of Cheyenne
The City's audited financial statements can be found on its website
www.cheyennecity.org**

Attachment 6: Current Financial Audit

ANNUAL AUDIT

Youth Alternatives is a department of the City of Cheyenne, it is audited as a part of the City audit. This audit takes place at the end of the City's fiscal year, which is June 30. The audit is conducted in accordance with Government Auditing Standards issued by the Comptroller General of the United States. A copy of the Youth Alternatives audit is included in the City's audit and is available in the City Treasure's Office. A copy of the audit can also be found on its website, www.cheyennecity.org.

Attachment 7: Certificate of Good Standing

**The Certificate of Good Standing
is not applicable for this grant
according to Lori A. Galles,
Purchasing Representative D.F.S.**

Attachment 8: Copy of Previous Progress Reports

**Please see attached copy of
FAMILY PRESERVATION
Quarterly Progress Report
December, 2009 - March, 2010**

Attachment 9: Officers and Board of Directors

List of Board Members or Shareholders

City of Cheyenne

Richard Kaysen, Mayor

City Council

Amber Ash

Judy Case

Jimmy Valdez

Patrick Collins

Dr. Mark Rinne

Jack Spiker

Jim Brown

Georgia Broyles

Don Pierson

ATTACHMENT B PROPOSED BUDGET

Program Title: Youth Alternatives Project H.O.M.E.

Date: 01-21-11

501(c)(3)	AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP	INCOME FROM OTHER SOURCES	TOTAL PROGRAM EXPENSES
PERSONNEL			
STAFF	\$20,000	\$5,100 (benefits)	\$25,100
CONSULTANTS			
TOTAL PERSONNEL A	\$20,000	\$5,100	\$25,100

NON-PERSONNEL			
SPACE COSTS (Rent/utilities)	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT	\$2,500	\$2,500
TELEPHONE			
POSTAGE			
CONSUMABLE SUPPLIES			
PRINTING			
TRAVEL	\$2,400		\$2,400
EQUIPMENT	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT		
OTHER COSTS			
Administrative		\$2,000	\$2,000
TOTAL NON-PERSONNEL B.	\$2,400	\$4,500	\$6,900
TOTAL AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP IS A+B+C	\$22,400	\$9,600	\$32,000
(1) Include a narrative of specific costs such as workshop mailing, materials, books, pamphlets and staff (per hour, benefits, etc.)			
(2) Income from other sources can include in-kind match in such areas as office space, supplies, equipment, utility costs and volunteer services.			

REVISED - PROPOSED BUDGET

Program Title: Youth Alternatives Project H.O.M.E.

Date: 10-10-11

501(c)(3)	AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP	INCOME FROM OTHER SOURCES	TOTAL PROGRAM EXPENSES
PERSONNEL			
STAFF	\$22,400.00	\$5,100 (benefits)	\$27,500.00
CONSULTANTS			
TOTAL PERSONNEL A	\$22,400.00	\$5,100	\$27,500.00

NON-PERSONNEL			
SPACE COSTS (Rent/utilities)	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT	\$2,500	\$2,500
TELEPHONE			
POSTAGE			
CONSUMABLE SUPPLIES			
PRINTING			
TRAVEL			
EQUIPMENT	NOT FUNDED BY THIS GRANT	0	0
OTHER COSTS		0	0
Administrative		\$2,000	\$2,000
TOTAL NON-PERSONNEL B.		\$4,500	\$4,500
TOTAL AMOUNT REQUESTED FROM FPP IS A+B+C	\$22,400	\$9,600	\$32,000
(1) Include a narrative of specific costs such as workshop mailing, materials, books, pamphlets and staff (per hour, benefits, etc.)			
(2) Income from other sources can include in-kind match in such areas as office space, supplies, equipment, utility costs and volunteer services			